

Sprint Review and Retrospective

SNHU Travel Project

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Applying Scrum Roles

The different Scrum roles helped the SNHU Travel project move forward because each person had a clear focus. The Product Owner represented the customer and organized the product backlog. This role helped the team understand that the most important goal was not simply to build a travel website, but to create a useful experience for customers. When the requirements called for the top five destinations, the Product Owner could explain the expected content and place that work at the right priority.

The Scrum Master helped the team follow the Scrum process and kept meetings focused. This role also helped remove problems that could slow down the sprint. As the Developer, I turned the user stories and acceptance criteria into working features. The Tester checked the feature from the user's point of view and looked for missing information or errors. Testing was part of the team's work instead of something saved for the very end. These roles supported one another: the Product Owner explained what was valuable, the Developer and Tester created a usable result, and the Scrum Master helped the team work effectively.

Completing User Stories

User stories made the work easier to understand because they described who needed a feature, what the person needed, and why it mattered. One SNHU Travel story asked for a way to view the top five travel destinations. Its acceptance criteria required each destination to include a name, a short description, an image, and travel package information. Those details gave the team a shared definition of what the completed feature should include.

The Agile SDLC helped the story move through planning, design, development, testing, and review in a small cycle. During Sprint Planning, the team selected the story and broke it into

manageable tasks. Development and testing happened during the sprint, so problems could be found before the Sprint Review. The Product Owner then reviewed the working feature against the acceptance criteria. If something was missing, the story could return to the backlog for refinement instead of being treated as complete. This process kept the team focused on a usable increment rather than partially finished work.

Handling Interruptions and Changes

A major change in the project was the move from a basic list of destinations to an updated slide show format. In a plan-driven project, that change could have required the team to revise a large design document and redo work that had already been approved. Scrum made the change easier to manage because the team expected the backlog to change as the customer learned more about the product.

The Product Owner could update the story, clarify the new acceptance criteria, and reorder the backlog. As the Developer, I could focus on the affected parts of the program rather than starting the entire project again. The team could discuss the change during backlog refinement and Sprint Planning, then demonstrate the updated display during the next Sprint Review. The short feedback cycle reduced the risk of continuing with a format the customer no longer wanted.

Communication

Regular communication helped prevent team members from making different assumptions about the same story. During a Daily Scrum, I could give a short update such as: “Yesterday I connected the destination data to the page. Today I am working on the slide controls. I am blocked because one image path is not loading.” This message explains progress,

the next step, and a problem that may need help. It gives the Scrum Master and the rest of the team enough information to respond without turning the meeting into a long status report.

Communication with the Product Owner was also important when a requirement was unclear. For example, I could ask: “Should every destination use the same package fields, and does the slide show need to rotate automatically?” The Product Owner's answer could be added to the acceptance criteria so the Developer and Tester used the same expectation. At the Sprint Review, the team could demonstrate the feature and ask whether the result matched the customer's needs. These short, direct conversations were more useful than waiting until the end of the project to discover a misunderstanding.

Organizational Tools and Scrum Events

The product backlog and sprint backlog were the most useful organizational tools. The product backlog kept all requested work in one ordered place, while the sprint backlog showed the smaller set of work selected for the current sprint. A task board with To Do, In Progress, Testing, and Done columns made progress visible. It also showed when too much work was started at once or when an item was waiting for testing.

The Scrum events gave the team a regular rhythm. Sprint Planning set a clear Sprint Goal and selected realistic work. Daily Scrums helped the Developers adjust their plan and raise blockers. Sprint Reviews brought the team and stakeholders together to inspect the working increment and discuss the backlog. Sprint Retrospectives focused on how the team worked and identified one or two improvements for the next sprint. Timeboxing kept these events focused. Transparency, inspection, and adaptation made the tools useful because the team did not only track work; it used the information to make decisions.

Evaluating the Agile Process

Overall, Scrum-Agile was a good choice for the SNHU Travel project. The project included customer-facing features, visual design decisions, and changing requirements. Those conditions made frequent feedback valuable. Working in small increments allowed the team to test one story, show it to the Product Owner, and improve it before too much time was spent on the wrong solution. The change from a basic list to a slide show is a clear example of why flexibility mattered.

Scrum also had limits. Meetings take time, the Product Owner must be available, and an unclear backlog can still cause confusion. The team also needs discipline to finish work and meet the Definition of Done. Even with those challenges, the benefits were stronger for this project. Better visibility, earlier testing, and faster response to feedback reduced risk and supported a more useful product. Waterfall could work for a project with stable requirements and strict approval steps, but Scrum fit SNHU Travel because the team needed to learn and adjust while building the application.

AI-Use Acknowledgment

I used ChatGPT (OpenAI, 2026) to format this document. I reviewed and revised the content so it reflects my understanding of the SNHU Travel project and the course concepts.

